

r/SideProject

# I'm building a browser extension that shows the real-time carbon footprint of your AI use (e.g., ChatGPT). Would love feedback!

Posted by u/RubberBubbleWrap\_ • 0 points • 1 comments

Hey y'all!

I've been working on a side project that tries to make the environmental impact of AI usage a bit more visible.

We always hear about emissions from flights, meat, or cars, but I recently came across data showing that large language models (like GPT) have a surprisingly large carbon and water footprint, even during regular use:

- \* GPT-3 training emitted ~552 metric tons of CO<sub>2</sub> (~500 round-trip flights NY↔SF)
- \* AI-generated images can emit as much CO<sub>2</sub> as driving ~3 miles
- \* A single ChatGPT session can use around 500 mL of water for cooling

So I'm building a browser extension that gives users:

- \* A real-time footprint score (CO<sub>2</sub> + water) after each ChatGPT session
- \* A tracker for usage trends over time
- \* Little suggestions to reduce impact (e.g., more concise prompts, using lighter tools when possible)

I'm still prototyping and figuring out the best way to estimate things accurately — but I'd love to hear your thoughts!

If you're curious, I've put together a rough landing page with more info:

[<https://gaiafootprint.carrd.co>](<https://gaiafootprint.carrd.co>)

Totally open to feedback, criticism, or new directions. Thanks!

## Comments

Love the eco-angle – how many users actually change behavior after seeing their AI footprint stats?